Fall 2006

The Mountainside



Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume IX Issue 1

From the President by Jim Thompson

It was great to see so many of you at the Annual Meeting weekend July 29th and 30th. Thanks to all who made the weekend a success and to all of you who are volunteering your time to CMA!

At the Annual Meeting, the proposed amendments to the CMA Bylaws were approved. This action aligns our CMA fiscal year with the calendar year and will require a Special Membership Meeting on November 11 to approve an assessment and budget for the new 2007 fiscal year. We will also be asking the membership to extend the terms of all seven current Board members by six months to align with the new fiscal year.



Jim Thompson, President, at Annual Meeting

These changes will improve the transition from one Board to the next by having a few months between elections and the start of the new Board. This will allow new Board members to become familiar with CMA issues and more time to determine how Board members are best suited for the various positions. We can also look forward to Annual Meetings in the September-October time frame when it is cooler and most members are back from vacation.

Also on the agenda is Coolfont Development by Freeman Companies, high speed internet access and Firewise Day Schedule.

Hot topics at the Annual Meeting included security, Freeman's development of Coolfont, road and house signage and paving of driveways. At least twenty-five member households also expressed interest in getting high speed internet service to the mountainside. (continued on p 3)

Coolfont Plans Emerge by Mary

Carl Freeman Co., the blue chip Maryland resort development firm which acquired the Coolfont Resort, the adjoining Ashelman Family property, and the Benedikt Farms last year, unveiled their initial vision for developing this 940 acre tract after a planning session held at Coolfont September 12-16. The five days of meetings by Freeman Company Executives, with architects, infrastructure and design consultants was interspersed with several extended public dialogue sessions where CMA, the town of Bath, local business people, and residents from throughout the area offered advice, objectives and their dreams for Coolfont's future, many of which were visible in the impressive plan unveiled at the charette's conclusion. (continued on page 6)

Calendar Of Events

October 21

10a.m. Board Meeting
CMA Office
12 noon Pool Cleanup Day
6:30p.m. Potluck (TBA)

October 21 & 22

Berkeley Springs Studio Tour & Art Sale
10am-5pm

November 11

10a.m. Board Meeting, CMA Off
1-3pm Special Membership Meeting—Best Western Inn

- Vote to extend terms of current board members
- Fiscal Year 2007 Assessments and Budget Dis.
- Firewise Day Schedule
- Coolfont Dev. Carl Freeman Companies
- High Speed Internet Acceess for the Mountainside

6:30p.m. Potluck Dinner
TBA

Fire Strikes the Courthouse

by Lois Copeland

Fire struck the old courthouse Tuesday, September 8. The fire alarm sounded at 4:30a.m., but smoke was detected by video as early as 7:00p.m. Monday evening.

The fire burned through the second floor, from the courtroom into sections of the circuit clerk's office, two buildings away. The main courthouse and the annex buildings appear to be a total loss. Insurance adjustors are still assessing damages. Old wiring was probably the cause of the fire, reports the State Fire Marshall 's Office.

County offices are operating from three double wide trailers equipped with electricity, phone, internet, water and sewer.

The fire-proofed vault in the County Clerk's office, closed and locked, saved deeds, liens, wills, marriage, birth, and death certificates. These documents have been transported to Ft. Worth, TX for preservation. Some of the documents suffered water damage.



Extensive damage to courthouse

The yellow brick courthouse was completed September, 1908, the third since Morgan County was created in March, 1820. The annex was added in 1953, with additional offices added from storefronts in 1974.

Many feel the yellow brick and limestone courthouse with the imposing clock tower was the face of Berkeley Springs. Will the new building add to the charm of Berkeley Springs or be just another non descript structure?

Photo by Dennis Brydges.

Visitors on the Mountainside

by Lois Copeland

Dennis and Evelyn Brydges were surprised when a black bear came calling. They reported hearing noise, looked out their window and found their humming bird feeder knocked over. It was then they spotted the brown bear.

Evelyn thought the bear was just two years old and recently left his mother's care. Evelyn was probably right.

Bear cubs are usually born in January or February, weaned at about seven months and will remain with the mother until the next summer. So our visitor was about 18 months old.

Black bears are considered omnivorous, have a keen sense of smell and hearing and are attracted to bird feeders in their quest for an easy meal. Not to worry Evelyn and Dennis: black bears are seldom aggressive towards humans.

Our next visitor was spotted on the driveway of the Wohl's yet completed home—a rattlesnake, a five rattler. So what is a five rattle rattlesnake? A snake is born with one rattle. Each time the snake sheds its skin a new rattle segment is added. Rattlesnakes shed their skin several times a year, depending on food supply, growth rates and whether the rattle breaks. Yes, their rattles can break.

The workers quickly, but carefully disposed of the snake.

Rattlesnakes' venom is poisonous, but they attack only when feeling threatened.



Photo of brown bear by Dennis Brydges

CMA Development Task Force Meets

by Carroll Yingling

The Board's Development Task Force met on August 26, with Jackson Bain, Stan Bigelow, Joan Claybrook, Dick Lehman, Jim Thompson, Cindy Van Meter, Ron Wohl and Carroll Yingling attending.

The specific purpose of the meeting was defined as providing the CMA Board and members with strategy options as we interface with the Carl Freeman Company and with other entities (county, state, federal) which have a bearing on the proposed development at Coolfont.

After a sharing of concerns and lively discussion, a seven-pronged strategy was agreed upon, with members of the TF and others called up to help with its implementation. Specifics of the strategy are available to all members. Do not hesitate to call or email Carroll Yingling, or any other member of the Task Force.



Carroll Yingling, heading task force.

A part of the strategy was to make sure that CMA's interests were well represented at the Carl Freeman Company Charrette, on September 12-15.

Meet the New Owner by Elmer Broxson

(The following article is based on the materials given to the CMA Board at its meeting with representatives of the Carl Freeman Companies on December 3, 2005 shortly after it purchased the Ashelman holdings which adjoin the CMA on three sides. The fourth side, the west, is the Cacapon State Park.)

Carl M. Freeman founded his company in 1946 to fill the need for post WW II housing and concentrated on building "GI bungalows" and garden apartments in Montgomery and Prince Georges counties. In 1967 he began the company's major role in shopping center development in the Washington region with the opening of the Cabin John Mall. Also in the late 1960s (when Sam Ashelman began to develop Coolfont as a second home community) Freeman started a beachfront tennis resort—the Sea Colony in Bethany Beach, Delaware. In the 1970s and '80s he continued to build in the Washington area and, unlike many developers, managed to weather the real estate bust of the late 1980s.

A major expansion of the company began in the early '90s when the founder, Carl, named his son, Joshua, as president. The father played a diminishing role in the company until his death in an auto accident in 1998. The younger Freeman had an unusual career before joining his father's business in 1986. After high school in Montgomery County he dropped out of college to serve in the Army's elite force, the Green Berets. Perhaps this explains his penchant for bonding with friends and employees by expeditions in skydiving and whitewater rafting. On the other hand it could probably explain only two of his three favorite historical figures—Winston Churchill, Mahatma Ghandhi and Ronald Reagan.



Joshua Freeman

Initially the expansion was in shopping centers in the D.C. area—Ashburn, Great Falls and Fairfax in Virginia and Rockville and Olney in Maryland—and in two luxury developments in Delaware, The Preserve and The Cove. In 1998 Joshua began to shift his focus from the Washington area shopping centers to developing golf courses and golf communities in Delaware, Maryland and Virginia, the largest being Bear Trap Dunes and Bayside—both in Delaware. Between 2001 and 2003 the company started four new companies to facilitate its real estate sales: realty, mortgage, title and real estate services. In an interview published in Professional Builder in March 2000, Freeman explained his new business strategy. "All of our production is second homes in resort locations, in the seashore area of Delaware. We've sold 3000 acres in the Washington, D.C. suburbs in favor of 1400 acres in Delaware. We don't want to compete with the big production builders and accept their margins. We make much better margins in the resort areas." Thanks to the internet an additional selling point for these resort locations is the possibility of working from home. As one executive put it, "Our buyers are people who live within a four or five hour drive from here, people who like the flexibility of being able to work from home, keep in touch with their friends and family in other places and be tied in to this neighborhood, too." (As quoted in the Washington Times, Sept. 29, 2000)

This, then, is a brief profile of the company that replaced Ashelman as our neighbor and with whom we have many legal ties. In addition to Coolfont, the company has purchased a 3500 acre tract near Ashville, NC with a view to developing mountain resorts as well as beach. The CMA Board has asked the company to keep us informed of their plans since we are their neighbors and potentially their best customers.

While not as timely as we would have liked, Freeman notified Morgan County, Berkeley Springs and CMA about holding a charatte Sept 12-15. Our members attended and felt that communication would improve.

From the President by Jim Thompson

(continued from page 1)

All of these issues will be high priority for the Board. All Board members will maintain the same positions they had for the past year.

In addition to the Special Meeting and monthly Potluck dinners, the CMA fall schedule includes a Pool Beautification Day on October 21st (when the leaves should be at their peak autumn color) and our annual Firewise Day on November 11th. Please put these events on your calendar and plan to join us!



New members Ivy and Saleem Hylton listen raptly during annual meeting.



CMA members at Annual Meeting

Our traditional dinner at the barn was as lively as ever. Kudos for Elmer Broxson. Did he have anything to do with the break in the heat?

By Lois Copeland

What's Happening in the Pasture by Elmer Broxson

In the 1970s the West Virginia Department of Natural Resources (now the Department of Environmental Protection) urged WV owners of undeveloped land to plant a bush called the Russian Olive to attract and shelter wildlife. Coolfont's developer, Sam Ashelman, complied by having hundreds planted on CMA's sewage lagoon dikes. From there they spread to the pasture. The DEP now considers the plant an invasive species and has requested that it be controlled if not eradicated.

In response I contracted to have the largest concentration in the pasture bulldozed—leaving a half-acre patch of exposed soil. I will seed the area with clover which, in addition to preventing erosion, is the most nutritious source of natural deer food available. For members with mainly practical concerns this grove of Russian Olive bushes was beginning to block our sole access to the construed wetland which we built I 1993 and must maintain as the final stage in processing our sewage. If you have any questions please call me at (202) 333-8872.



Downed Russian Olive Bushes

Editor's note: I would like to see a wild flower meadow, along with the clover.

Lois Copeland

Good Eats at Jakes

by Lois Copeland

You are hungry, don't feel like cooking, you want to relax and so few restaurants to choose from. What do you do. You'll find 'good eats' at Jakes.

Jakes Sports Bar and Grill opened April 2006, formerly The Wheel House Inn, formerly The English Muffin owned by Betty Stone. Betty still prepares the famous and delicious crab cakes.

Jakes is unique, it is not just a sports bar. Jakes is a family restaurant; non smoking. The sport's bar is located in another room. TVs' are located in the main restaurant, also.

The varied menu includes munchies, dinner entrees, salads, sandwiches, pizza, subs, a children's menu, desserts and beer and wine.

Friends and I visited Jakes three or four times. We ordered the spring rolls, onion rings, crab stuffed mushrooms, wings, and nacho's supreme from the munchies menu. For dinner we ordered crab cake platters, butterfly shrimp platter, the southern fried chicken platter, a large pizza, the 12" cheese steak sub, and the New York strip steak, wine, beer, and the key lime pie for dessert. We enjoyed the food, the portions big and the service excellent and friendly.

Jakes is owned by John Kiley. The name stems from John's college days. He and his friends talked about opening up a sport's bar and the name would be "Jakes".



Debbie, the manger stresses that Jakes is a family restaurant. Wednesday night is Karaoke Night and the kids love it. Monday is Monday Night Football with wings and beer, Thursday is Steak Night. They are planning a Halloween Dance Friday October 27.

Located at 9520 Valley Rd, 258-9660. Hrs. M-Th 11-10, F & S 11-11, S 12N-8

Colonial Woodworkers Opens

by Lois Copeland

Larry Merola, our friend and CMA resident opened Colonial Woodworkers in Berkeley Springs. The shop is located on North Washington Street.

Larry makes custom-made traditional, colonial, Early American and contemporary woodworking pieces. His long time hobby, taught to him by his grandfather, now is a second career.

Merola, a biochemist by profession, retired from the National Institute of Health (NIH) in 1999. It was then that he was able to go from tinkering to serious woodworking.

The woodworker has made dining room tables, bookcases, coffee tables, chairs, bookshelves and hand-chiseled wood carvings for lamp stands.

Colonial Woodworkers donates wood scraps to Starting Points, a family resource center. He wants to pass on his love of woodworking to the youth of this community.



Larry Merola

Mr. Merola is a renaissance man. In addition to woodworking, he is a fine chef, specializing in Italian cooking, and loves the opera.

Larry is married to Flo Merola a person with many interests, including cooking and decorating.

The Farmers Market

by Carroll and Phyllis Yingling

It is a typical Sunday morning in downtown Berkeley Springs. Market 5 Master Bob Mann has just rung the 10am market bell to open The Market and local folks, tourists, church goers and leavers begin to mingle and circulate among the sixteen vendors who string out their wares in stalls along East Fairfax Street.

The Market provides a weekly bouquet of *color*...reds and greens and purples and yellows; a feast of *aromas*...pork sausages and Italia sandwiches and freshly popped popcorn and newly brewed coffee; and a broad array of *textures*....vegetables, fruits, jams, jellies, herbs and native plants that appeal to all our senses. All of these pleasures add up to great values for local products and an enjoyable way to spend an hour or so....and a few dollars....on Sunday morning.

For Phyllis, a major treat was chatting with the vendors....even discovering cousins from Berkeley County selling vegetables at Burkhart's Market. There were other young entrepreneurs from the Back Creek Valley....Herbal medicines from Peace in the Valley at Jones' Springs and cut flowers from Heron's Rest Farm in Shanghai. Jeanine Glasscock's herbs and flowers are grown right here on Highland Ridge Rd. in Berkeley Springs, while the jams and cookies of Sylvan Farms come from Mercersburg, PA. The fresh meats of Fertile Plains Custom Pork come from Mohler's Crossroads ear Martinsburg. Margie Brown, a local businesswoman who owns Daydreams, can give you 21 reasons to use Shea Butter, a skin cream produced by the African Women's Cooperative in Northern Uganda/Southern Sudan.



Market home canned food items!

When you need a cup of coffee, Donna's Coffee Stop, located at 758 S. Washington St., provides fresh coffee at a booth in the market. At the Master Gardeners' stall, we picked up flyers from the Extension Service of WVU that provide excellent information on gardening, as well as all the services provided by the university for people who want to grow their own food and flowers. The 2006 Garden Calendar, packed full of tips from the WVU Extension experts, will be a great help as we tend our 10' by 10' urban patch.

The Market is open Sundays 10 AM-2 PM, April 30-October 29, 2006 and is located at the intersection of Rt. 522 and Fairfax St. in beautiful downtown Berkeley Springs.

Whether you buy anything or not, a visit to the Farmers Market is pure delight!



Bouquet of colors-reds, greens, yellows.



Corn eating contest several weeks ago!



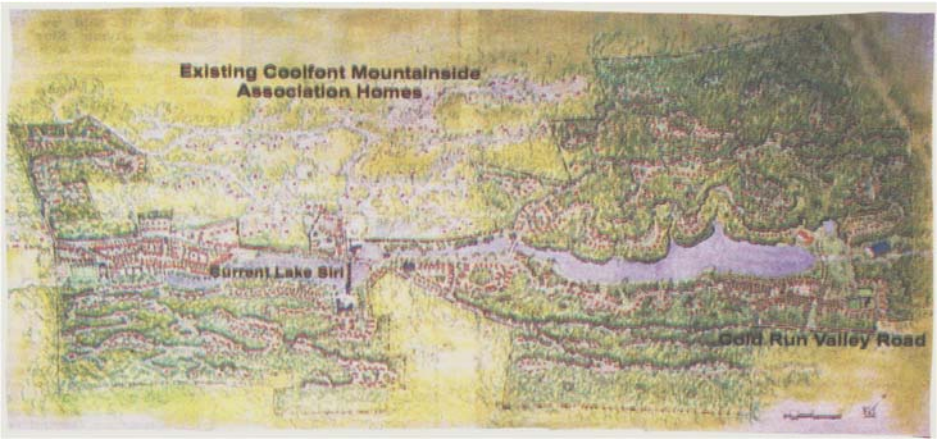
Sentiments of your newsletter editor and many others, I think.

Future Look of Coolfont Resort

by Lois Copeland

This map shows the future look of Coolfont. It shows clusters of housing and resort facilities and a reshaped lake. Each cluster mixes styles and sizes of housing units. After December 31, the spa, pool, and home rentals, etc. will be completely shutdown.

Freeman Companies has not yet applied for Morgan County Planning Commission approval of any development plans or submitted any designs to the planning board.



Coolfont Mountainside Association

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Time to welcome the beauty of fall colors.



Coolfont Resort Plans Emerge

(Continued from page 1)

The results, while preliminary and subject to refinement, are ambitious.

A 15-20 year span to build-out is projected. Development will be south to North with groundbreaking late in 2007 or early spring of 2008. The Freeman Co. will start from scratch. The only existing amenities that will remain in any form are Lake Siri which will be deepened and enlarged and the Manor House. The lake will be widened and lengthened at the western end now abutting Cold Run Valley. A second, larger lake will be added further to the north extending across the Benedikt Farm to a second dam at the Farm's northern boundary. Cold Run Valley Road will cross the refigured Lake Siri on a causeway. The area surrounding the existing Coolfont resort will be the "resort' component of the plan with a greater concentration of spa and recreational facilities. The development around the second lake will be the "retreat" aspect with a greater concentration of residences scattered in clusters or "hamlets".

Phase I of the development, the "Village" will begin at the southern end of the property where the current spa and the Treetop are located. It will include: Two community pavilions housing multi-purpose rooms, a post office, the Freeman sales center, the design center, a nature center, a "diner", an outdoor amphitheatre, a lake front park with a year round ice skating rink, Cool Essentials (a 2500 SF convenience store) and 30 "live/work" homes. Live work homes are 3 stories. The idea is to work in the 1st or lower level and to live in the upper 2 levels. The vision is to have a little artists/artisan colony in this location. Also in this area there are plans for an outdoor fitness area which would include an outdoor pool, tennis courts, volley ball and basketball facilities. Residences of several types will be located in the surrounds.

Development Phase 2, the "Mill" is towards the center of the development and is to include a Mill and the Spa/Inn. The Mill's location is on the western shore near where the 2 lakes join. It will be an operating mill to be used during the building process. Additionally, it will house a 15,000 SF fitness center. The spa/inn will be located across the lake roughly between the snow tubing/ chalet and the eastern end of the present Lake Siri dam location. The spa will be world class and includes an indoor pool. The inn is projected to have 40 rooms.

On the west side of the lake: The Manor House will be an executive retreat. There will be a signature restaurant (10,000SF) across Herbert Quick Drive from the Manor House with a long view of the new lake. Across the lake (east) and close to the spa/inn will be lake front cottage rentals (20-40).

At the north east corner there will be an equestrian center with approximately a dozen horses. There will also be trails for hiking, biking, mountain biking and more rugged sports. A small lake front park for picnicking and relaxing will be in this location.

The development surrounding the new lake—or the "retreat" aspect—will include compact hamlets and preserved natural space. There will be a 8-20 living units in each hamlet and will include town homes, condos and single family dwellings. There is no plan to develop the high ridge.

On the 940 acres, the building projections are for 1100 second home units as follows:

586 single family homes

259 duplexes (or 518 units)*

95 town homes

30 live/work homes

130 condominiums

1100 units (1359 living units/ residences)*

Design focus includes interconnectivity of roads and pathways, "green" construction technologies, encouraging the energy of clustered living and the preservation of natural space.

The Freeman "5 minute walk" theory will apply: some amenities (dispersed throughout the community) should be but a five minute walk away. There will be residential development around both lakes and throughout the community. The south end will have integrated commercial and residential development.